THE CHALLENGE

What we're asking for

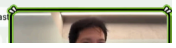
Create a working product that uses AI running locally on a user's device to solve a real problem.

Show why running AI locally creates an experience that would be difficult, expensive, slow, private, or impossible with a cloud-only approach.

ANY KIND OF PRODUCT

Productivity · Developer tools · Accessibility · Education · Finance · Gaming · Disas…

Creative tools · Enterprise tools · Computer vision · Personal assistants · Privacy tools



TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

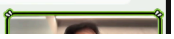
Rules

Required

- Substantially built during the hackathon
- A meaningful part of AI inference executes locally
- A working product, demonstrated
- Models, APIs, frameworks, and major tools disclosed
- Core Local AI functionality works without depending entirely on a cloud AI API

Allowed

- Existing open-source models and libraries
- AI-assisted development
- Devin
- Cloud APIs as secondary components

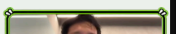


EXAMPLE TECHNOLOGIES

Tools you can use

Ollama	LM Studio	llama.cpp	MLX
ONNX	PyTorch	TensorFlow	WebGPU
Core ML	AMD ROCm	DirectML	Hugging Face

Plus open-source LLMs, vision models, and speech models. No specific model, framework, operating system, or hardware platform is required.



TEAM STRUCTURE

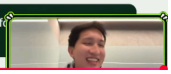
Teams

1–4
members per team

Solo
builders are allowed

Remote
work from anywhere throughout October 9

Teams that want to be finalists must be present at Cyberzone, SM Makati f… October 10.



WHO CAN COMPETE

Eligibility

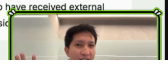
Only participants listed on the official AppBuildersPH website are allowed to compete.
appbuildersph.com/hackathon

Allowed

You can still change teams or your team name, as long as you submit your official team name and member names from the official website list.

Disqualified

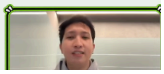
- Members not on the official list
- Participants proven to have received external help from people outsi…



Judging criteria

25%	25%	20%	15%	15%
Problem & Usefulness Does it solve a genuine problem for a clear target user?	**Local AI Implementation** Is local inference fundamental, and does it give a meaningful advantage?	**Technical Execution** Does it actually work, reliably enough for a live demonstration?	**Innovation** Is it meaningfully different? Does Local AI enable something new?	**Product & Demo Quality** Is the UX usable, and is the live demonstration convincing?

Half the score is usefulness and how real your Local AI is.



Submission checklist

The project

- Project name
- Short description
- Team members
- Public GitHub repository

The proof

- Demo video
- X / LinkedIn video URL
- What runs locally
- What requires internet

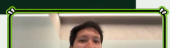
The disclosures

- Models used
- Technologies and frameworks
- APIs and cloud services
- Existing code and assets
- AI development tools

EVERY SUBMISSION MUST ANSWER

Why does this product benefit from running AI locally?

Submission deadline: 10:00 AM, October 10. No extensions.



TOMORROW · OCTOBER 10 · CYBERZONE, SM MAKATI

Demo Day schedule

12:00 PM	Registration and participant arrival	1:40 PM	Finalist pitching begins
12:15 PM	Demo and AV technical checks	3:20 PM	Break and networking
1:00 PM	Official opening and AppBuildersPH welcome	3:40 PM	Finalist pitching continues
1:15 PM	PCExpress welcome	5:00 PM	Judging deliberation, PC Express auction and raffle
1:20 PM	AMD segment	5:45 PM	Awards ceremony
1:30 PM	Cognition / Devin segment	6:30 PM	Networking
		7:00 PM	Event ends



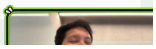
KEEP THESE OPEN

Links

OFFICIAL APPBUILDERS HACKATHON WEBSITE
appbuildersph.com/hackathon

HACKATHON PAGE
cerebralvalley.ai/e/appbuildersph-hackathon-2026

TELEGRAM GROUP CHAT
t.me/+uxlZLV5_jEZjMDNl



Rules and tools

Can we use cloud APIs?
Yes, as secondary components. Your core Local AI functionality must not depend entirely on a cloud AI API.

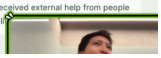
Can we use AI coding tools like Devin?
Yes. AI-assisted development and Devin are allowed. Disclose the tools you used.

Can we use open-source models and libraries?
Yes. Disclose every model, framework, and API in your submission.

Can we reuse code we wrote before today?
Your project must be substantially built during the hackathon. Disclose any existing code or assets.

Do we need a specific model, OS, or hardware?
No. Any model, framework, operating system, or hardware platform works.

Can people outside the hackathon help us?
No. Participants proven to have received external help from people outside the hackathon are disqual…



Build Day and videos

Can we build from anywhere?
Yes. Build Day is fully remote, and teams continue building overnight.

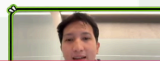
Where do we ask questions during the build?
Post in the official Telegram group chat.

How long should the demo video be?
Ideally around 1 minute.

Is the X or LinkedIn video post required?
Yes. Tag Devin / Cognition and include #AppBuildersPH.

What do we need to disclose?
Models, frameworks, APIs and cloud services, existing code and assets, and the AI development tools you used.

Can our project be a mobile app or run on hardware?
Yes.



Submissions

Where do we submit?
On the Cerebral Valley event page:
cerebralvalley.ai/e/appbuildersph-hackathon-2026

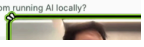
When is the deadline?
10:00 AM, October 10. No extensions.

Can we edit or resubmit?
No. Each team submits only once, so check everything before you submit.

Does our GitHub repository need to be public?
Yes. It must be public by the 10:00 AM deadline.

Can we keep committing after the deadline?
No. Code freezes at 10:00 AM, and judges review the repository as of the deadline.

What must every submission answer?
Why does this product benefit from running AI locally?



FAQ · 7 OF 7

Other questions

Does the app need to be deployed live?
No, as long as your repository has instructions for judges to recreate it.

What if a team member drops out?
Only the member names in your submission are counted.

How many finalists will there be?
10 to 15 finalist teams.

Will there be certificates of participation?
Yes, on the AppBuildersPH website.

Who do we contact with concerns on Demo Day?
Bryl Lim or any of the organizing members.

